

ENTRY SCREENING & SELF-DETERMINATION ACKNOWLEDGMENT

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Purpose (read first):

This screening confirms an individual's **capacity for self-directed living without services or supervision**.

It does **not** assess worthiness, behavior control, social preferences, or relationship choices.

SECTION 1 — CORE ELIGIBILITY (NON-NEGOTIABLE)

The applicant must answer YES to all items below.

- ☐ I understand this is independent housing, not assisted or supervised living.
- ☐ I am capable of performing all daily living activities independently.
- ☐ I understand no personal care, medical care, or supervision is provided.
- ☒ I can independently seek help when needed (family, friends, providers, or emergency services).
- ☐ I accept full responsibility for my health, safety, and personal decisions.

If any answer is NO → IL is not appropriate at this time.

(That is a placement decision, not a judgment.)

SECTION 2 — FUNCTIONAL SELF-MANAGEMENT SCREEN

The applicant must demonstrate ability in the following areas:

A. Daily Living

- ☐ Manages personal hygiene independently
- ☐ Prepares or obtains meals independently
- ☐ Manages laundry and housekeeping independently
- ☐ Maintains a personal schedule without reminders

B. Health & Safety

- ☐ Manages medications independently (if applicable)
- ☐ Schedules and attends medical appointments independently
- ☐ Can identify when emergency services are needed
- ☐ Can call 911 or emergency contacts without assistance

C. Decision-Making

- ☐ Understands personal risks and consequences
- ☐ Makes informed choices without staff direction
- ☐ Can refuse services or seek them externally if desired

SECTION 3 — HOUSING & COMMUNITY COMPATIBILITY

(This is NOT behavior control. It is standard housing suitability.)

- ☐ Can comply with a normal lease or occupancy agreement
- ☐ Can coexist in shared housing without supervision
- ☐ No history of violent behavior toward others
- ☐ Understands that conflicts are handled personally, not by staff intervention

 Note:

Emotional expression, relationships, visitors, disagreement, or personal struggles are **not disqualifiers**.

SECTION 4 — VISITOR & RELATIONSHIP AFFIRMATION (CRITICAL)

Read carefully. Initial each line.

- ☐ I understand I control my personal relationships and visitors.
- ☐ I understand visitors are **not staff, not services, and not program activity**.
- ☐ I understand the program does not supervise or manage my visitors.
- ☐ I understand I am responsible for my guests' conduct.

This section exists to protect independence, not restrict it.

SECTION 5 — PROGRAM BOUNDARIES ACKNOWLEDGMENT

I understand and accept that the IL:

- ☐ Does not provide personal care
- ☐ Does not provide medical services
- ☐ Does not monitor daily activities
- ☐ Does not intervene in personal decisions
- ☐ Does not manage relationships or visitors
- ☐ Is not responsible for resident outcomes

I acknowledge that independence includes freedom and responsibility.

SECTION 6 — SELF-DETERMINATION STATEMENT (SIGNED)

"I am choosing Independent Living voluntarily. I understand that autonomy includes risk, responsibility, and personal decision-making. I do not expect supervision, care, or control from this program."

Applicant Name: applicant_name
Signature: applicant_signature
Date: date_applicant_signature

SECTION 7 — ADMINISTRATIVE DETERMINATION (STAFF)

- ☐ Eligible for IL (meets independence criteria)
☒ Not appropriate for ILF at this time (services required)

Decision is based solely on functional independence and informed choice.

Staff Signature: staff_signature
Date: date_staff_signature

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WHY THIS TOOL IS DEFENSIBLE (IMPORTANT)

This tool:

- Confirms **capacity**, not compliance
- Protects the program **without stripping autonomy**

- Avoids institutional logic
- Aligns with the true definition of Independent Living
- Prevents “problem-free by control” practices

This tool explicitly rejects:

- visitor bans
- behavioral engineering
- pre-institutional screening
- independence theft disguised as safety

ONE-LINE SUMMARY (for audits, boards, or complaints)

“This screening verifies independence by documenting self-direction and informed choice, not by restricting adult freedoms.”